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Project Title: Digital Literacy

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INTRODUCTION

Let's face it—being digitally savvy isn't optional anymore. It's as important as reading or math if you want to succeed in school or at work. Now that I'm a Student Digital Ambassador for our college, I get to help my classmates handle the digital world without getting lost or tripped up. That's where this Digital Literacy Portfolio comes in. It's not just a collection of tasks—it's proof that I know what I'm doing when it comes to creating clear visuals, building a genuine online presence, using coding and collaboration tools, writing proper emails, and spotting cybersecurity risks before they become problems. In five focused modules, I'll walk through exactly what I learned and how I did it. My goal? To hand every student here useful tips and trustworthy resources so all of us can move through the digital world with a little more skill and a lot more confidence.

TASK 1

For this task, I used Canva to put together a Digital Literacy Awareness infographic. Honestly, Canva made the whole process pretty smooth with its easy-to-use layout and a bunch of solid free templates, especially for educational stuff. I designed the infographic around three main points: what digital literacy actually is, how to stay safe online, and why it matters to keep things professional on the internet. The way I set it up, you go from learning the basics to picking up real safety tips, and then you end up with ideas on how to build a professional online reputation that can actually help with future jobs.

Figuring out how to balance all the text with visuals was more interesting (and tricky) than I expected. I had to trim down big ideas like cybersecurity and digital professionalism into short, clear bullet points that still got the message across. It was tough, but it felt good when everything clicked. In the end, I think this infographic does a good job turning must-know digital skills into something quick and easy to understand, so my batchmates can handle themselves better online.

TASK 2

I started by setting up and updating my profiles on GitHub and LinkedIn. GitHub's pretty much the go-to spot for developers—it lets me show off my coding projects and track my progress, which fits perfectly with my focus on Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning. I even customized my Profile README to highlight my interest in Large Language Models and my ambition to build real-world AI systems.

LinkedIn got a refresh, too. I made sure it lists my current academic status at VIT Bhopal since it's the main place where you connect with industry folks and hunt for internships.

For the next four years, GitHub's going to be my running record of every Python and ML project I work on. I'll keep adding new work as I learn and build. LinkedIn, on the other hand, will be where I share academic achievements, join tech conversations, and search for summer internships and research collaborations in AI.

TASK 3

This module pushed me to dive into both coding practice platforms and cloud collaboration tools. I went with HackerRank to sharpen my programming skills, taking on challenges like building a Multiset class and simulating a Vending Machine, all in Python. It's a great place to push your code and see how it holds up against some tough test cases.

For collaboration, I put together a 5-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. I mixed up multiple-choice and short-answer questions on topics like spotting phishing attempts and keeping passwords secure. Gathering responses was simple, and having everything instantly organized in a linked Google Sheet made analysis a breeze.

On the academic side, HackerRank gives me solid prep for technical interviews and competitive programming. Google Workspace tools, on the other hand, are perfect for group projects, quick classroom surveys, and collecting the kind of data I'll need for future research assignments.

TASK 4

While I was putting together some professional emails and a social media checklist, I started thinking about how easily bad digital communication spills over into real issues. Picture this: a student fires off a sloppy email to a professor—no subject line, way too casual, full of text-speak—asking for a recommendation letter. The professor can't tell who's writing or what's needed right away, so the email gets ignored. Suddenly, the student misses a scholarship deadline.

All of this could've been avoided with a little effort—a clear subject, proper greeting, quick explanation, and a simple sign-off. The main thing I got from this exercise? How you write online says a lot about you. If you keep your tone professional, structured, and respectful, you don't just avoid confusion—you build trust, and that often leads to bigger opportunities down the road.

TASK 5

Digging into UPI and online payment fraud for the cybercrime case study really opened my eyes. And honestly, I wasn't shocked by the technical tricks—they're not as advanced as you'd think. What caught me off guard was how much scammers lean on simple psychological games, especially making people feel rushed. Take the "Receive Money" scam: the fraudster doesn't hack anything complicated. They just push the victim into thinking they need to enter their UPI PIN to accept a payment, playing off trust and a sudden panic.

After seeing how easy it is to get fooled, I'm changing how I deal with digital messages. From now on, I'll take a breath and double-check before I click links, enter my PIN, or respond to any urgent money requests—even if they look like they're from someone I know or an official number.

Conclusion

Honestly, this Digital Literacy project was a practical and genuinely rewarding experience. It wasn't just theory—I got to apply things in real life. Building out a GitHub repository, practicing secure communication, and diving into real cyber threats gave me tools I'll actually use. I feel ready to handle the internet safely, use online platforms for school, and help other students grow good digital habits as a Student Digital Ambassador.

References

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GitHub - <https://github.com>

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HackerRank - <https://www.hackerrank.com>

Google Forms - <https://forms.google.com>